IELTS ACADEMIC · WRITING TASK 2

# Building a body paragraph with PEEL

*Argument structure for Writing Task 2*

LESSON 7 · 60 MIN · BAND 6.0 TO 6.5

*Prepared for Jordan by Lin Chen*

# Today's objectives

**BY THE END OF THIS LESSON, YOU CAN**

1. Name the four PEEL moves and what each one does.
2. Turn a vague opinion into one precise, arguable Point sentence.
3. Write a 120–150-word body paragraph in eight minutes.

**BAND FOCUS** Task Response · Coherence and Cohesion

# From last week's essay

**STUDENT'S SENTENCE**

Nowadays, many people thinks[1] that study other subject[2] is waste of time[3], but I think it have many advantage[4].

**REVISED**

Requiring students to take courses outside their major has one clear advantage: it develops the flexible thinking that employers value.

**WHY**

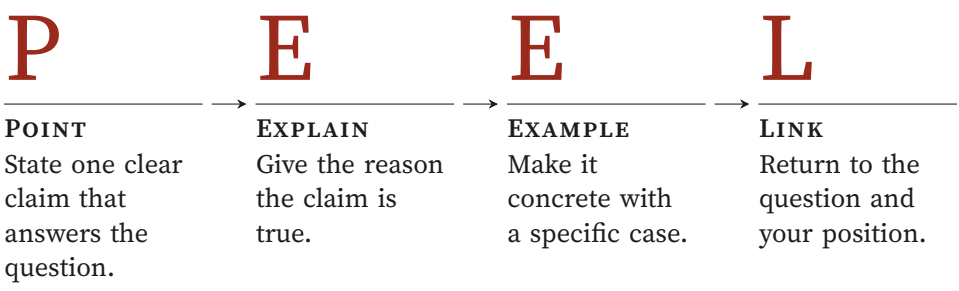
1 *many people think*: plural subject, plural verb

2 *studying other subjects*: a gerund as subject

3 *a waste of time*: the noun needs an article

4 *it has*, and name the advantage you mean

# Four moves, one argument




*Most Band 6 paragraphs jump from Point straight to Example. Explain is the move that lifts the band.*

# Say it before you write it

IELTS SPEAKING · PART 2 ⏱ 1 min to prepare · 1–2 min to speak

**Describe a subject you studied that was not part of your main interest.**

You should say:

- what the subject was
- when and where you studied it
- what you learned from it

and explain whether you think it was worth studying.

*Jordan speaks first. Then they write the same idea as one PEEL paragraph.*

# Write one body paragraph

8:00

COUNTDOWN

QUESTION

*Some people believe that university students should be required to take courses outside their main subject. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

| | |
|---|---|
| **0–1 min** | Plan: choose one Point and one example. |
| **1–6 min** | Write 120–150 words in PEEL order. |
| **6–8 min** | Check verb agreement, articles and the Link. |

# A model paragraph, move by move

**POINT** The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.

*One claim, and no examples yet.*

# A model paragraph, move by move

**POINT** The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.

**EXPLAIN** Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically.

*The reasoning: why the claim holds.*

# A model paragraph, move by move

**POINT** The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.

**EXPLAIN** Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically.

**EXAMPLE** For instance, a computer science student who takes an ethics module learns to ask not only whether software works, but whom it might harm.

*Specific and believable, not many people.*

# A model paragraph, move by move

| | |
|---|---|
| POINT | The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills. |
| EXPLAIN | Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically. |
| EXAMPLE | For instance, a computer science student who takes an ethics module learns to ask not only whether software works, but whom it might harm. |
| LINK | Broad requirements therefore produce more adaptable graduates, which is why I largely agree with this policy. *Returns to the question and the writer's position.* |

*One paragraph, one point.*
*Every other sentence serves it.*

RULE OF THUMB

# Summary and exit check

### TODAY

- A Point makes one specific claim.
- Explain gives the reason; Example makes it concrete.
- The Link answers the question, not the topic.

### WORDS TO REUSE

**transferable** /trænsˈfɜːrəbl/
useful in many situations

**compulsory** /kəmˈpʌlsəri/
required by rule

### EXIT CHECK

1. Which move is missing? “Online study saves time. For example, I save two hours a day.”
2. Correct this sentence: “It have many advantage.”
3. Write a Point sentence for: “Should museums be free?”